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وزارة الاتصالات وتكنولوجيا المعلومات

Digilians

Leadership Skills

Module Two

LEADERSHIP SKILLS

Participant's Manual

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Situational Leadership Styles

Situational Leadership Model

The Situational Leadership Model, developed by Paul Hersey and Ken Blanchard, is a framework where leaders adjust their style—ranging from directing to delegating—based on the performance readiness (competence and commitment) of their followers for a specific task. It prioritizes adapting behavior to improve team performance and flexibility.

Match your style to your team member's development level (D1–D4):

D1 = Low competence, high commitment

D2 = Some competence, low commitment

D3 = High competence, variable commitment

D4 = High competence, high commitment

Style	Description	Best for Teams That Are...
Directing/Telling (S1)	High task focus, low support focus. Leader gives clear instructions and closely supervises.	Inexperienced or new workers who lack competence but are enthusiastic.
Coaching/Selling (S2)	High task and high support. Leader explains decisions and encourages buy-in.	Workers who are somewhat capable but lack confidence or motivation.
Supporting/Participating (S3)	Low task, high support. Leader shares decision-making; workers have input.	Competent workers who may lack confidence or commitment.
Delegating (S4)	Low task, low support. Leader hands off responsibility.	Highly skilled, experienced, and self-motivated workers.

D1 = Low competence, High Commitment → DIRECTING

D2 = Some competence, Low commitment → COACHING

D3 = High competence, Variable commitment → SUPPORTING

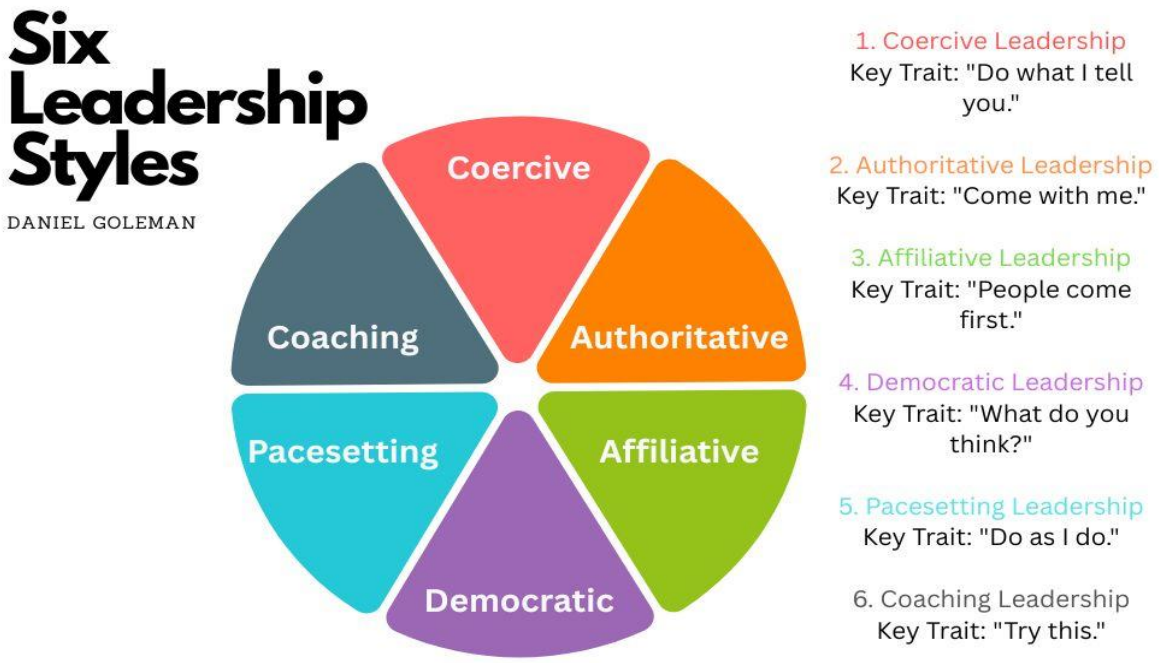
D4 = High competence, High commitment → DELEGATING

The Process for Using the Right Style

1. **Identify the Task:** Define the specific task and required skills.
2. **Assess Readiness:** Evaluate the employee's competence and commitment (D1-D4).
3. **Adapt Style:** Match the leadership style (S1-S4) to the readiness level.

The 6 Leadership Styles (Daniel Goleman)

Goleman's model outlines six leadership styles based on emotional intelligence. Each style can be effective depending on the situation.



Style	Description	Emotional Intelligence Competencies	Best Used When…
1. Coercive ("Do what I tell you")	Demands immediate compliance	Self-control, initiative	In a crisis or turnaround
2. Authoritative ("Come with me")	Mobilizes people toward vision	Self-confidence, empathy, change catalyst	When a new vision or direction is needed
3. Affiliative ("People come first")	Creates emotional bonds	Empathy, communication	To heal rifts or improve morale
4. Democratic ("What do you think?")	Builds consensus	Collaboration, communication	To gain input or build buy-in
5. Pacesetting ("Do as I do, now")	Sets high performance standards	Initiative, conscientiousness	With highly motivated, skilled teams
6. Coaching ("Try this")	Develops people	Empathy, self-awareness	To help employees improve performance or develop long term

Characteristics of the Six Styles

1. Leadership Style: Pacesetting

- Holds and exemplifies high standards for performance.
- Is obsessive about doing things faster and better.
- Asks others to do things to a high standard; and do them faster / better.
- Pinpoints poor performers, demands more from them.
- Rescues the situation if others don't perform, by assuming responsibility for the task or giving detailed instruction on "how to do it".
- Has little sympathy for poor performance.
- Seeks co-ordination with others only if it has an impact on an immediate task.
- Sees development of others as "showing them how to do it".

2. Leadership Style: Commanding

- Gives lots of directives by telling people what to do.
- Rarely seeks any input from the individual.
- Controls tightly through constant monitoring.
- Relies on corrective feedback to emphasize what is wrong and achieve compliance.
- Motivates others by emphasizing the consequences of getting it wrong.
- Can be closed to other styles of working; and may ridicule them as "soft".

3. Leadership Style: Visionary

- Takes responsibility for facilitating the development and communication of a clear vision of how things can be.
- Solicits individuals' perspectives on the vision without surrendering authority or undermining the integrity of the vision.
- Sees selling the vision as part of the leader's job.
- Influences others by explaining, exploring and describing the vision
- Ensures that others align the vision with their jobs and objectives.
- Uses a range of methods (both positive and negative) to enhance other's motivation and performance.

4. Leadership Style: Affiliative

- Places more emphasis on the individuals than the task in hand.
- Cares for the whole person.
- Shares his or her emotional challenges with the team members in an appropriate manner.
- Rewards personal characteristics and behaviours (the hows) as much as the delivery of the task.

5. Leadership Style: Democratic

- Trusts that individuals have the capability to develop the appropriate direction for themselves and their team.
- Invites individuals to make decisions affecting their work.
- Reaches decisions by consensus.
- Holds many meetings and listens to others' concerns.

- Rewards adequate performance and rarely gives negative feedback or punishes others

6. Leadership Style: Coaching

- Helps individuals identify their individual strengths and weaknesses in the light of their aspirations.
- Reaches agreement with individuals on both the manager's and the individual's roles in the development process.
- Provides on-going support, challenge and feedback.
- May trade-off short-term performance for longer term development.
- Share exciting assignments for development purposes.

When and How to Use Each Leadership Style

The Visionary Leader

When to Use It

Visionary leadership is most effective when the organization needs a new vision or a dramatic new direction, such as during a corporate turnaround. However, it's less likely to

be effective when you're working with a team more experienced than you are – here, democratic leadership is more likely to be effective. This leadership style can also be overbearing if you use it too often.

How to Develop It

To develop a visionary style, focus on increasing your expertise, vision, self-confidence and empathy. Get excited about change and let your team see your enthusiasm. You also need to convince others of your vision, so focus on improving your presentation skills.

The Coaching Leader

When to Use It

The Coaching style should be used whenever you have a team member who needs help building long-term skills, or if you feel that he or she is "adrift" in your organization and could benefit from a coaching or mentoring relationship. However, coaching can fail when it's used with an employee who is not making an effort, or who needs a lot of direction and feedback – here, pacesetting or Coercive leadership may be more appropriate.

How to Develop It

To develop a Coaching style, learn how to engage in informal coaching and mentoring.

It's also important to get to know the people on your team. When you know your people, you're better able to see when they need guidance or advice. Walk around to keep in touch with their needs.

The Affiliative Leader

When to Use It

Use this style whenever there is team tension or conflict, when trust has been broken, or if the team needs to be motivated through a stressful time.

How to Develop It

Leaders who use the Affiliative style are highly focused on emotion. So, learn how to resolve conflict and how to be optimistic.

The Democratic Leader

When to Use It

This style is best used when you need to get your team on board with an idea or build consensus. It's also effective when you need your team's input. The Democratic leadership style shouldn't be used with people who are inexperienced, lack competence, or aren't well

informed about a situation. It's best to ask for input from team members who are motivated, knowledgeable and capable.

How to Develop It

To develop a Democratic leadership style, involve your team in problem solving and decision making, and teach them the skills they need to do this. You should learn active listening and facilitation skills.

The Pacesetting Leader

When to Use It

The Pacesetting leadership style is best used when you need to get high quality results from a motivated team, quickly.

How to Develop It

Because the Pacesetting style focuses on high performance, learn how to improve the quality of your team's work using techniques like **Six Sigma** and **Kaizen**. Train your people properly and engage in **high-performance coaching** to help them become as effective as possible. You may also want to work on your **motivation skills**, so that you can get the best from your people.

The Commanding Leader

When to Use It

The Coercive leadership style is best used in crisis situations, to jump start fast-paced change, and with problem employees.

How to Develop It

Be cautious when setting out to develop a Coercive leadership style. Remember, this style is very easily misused, and should only be used when necessary. To work effectively in these high-pressure situations, learn how to manage crises, think on your feet, and make good decisions under pressure.

REMEMBER

No style is universally right or wrong — what matters is contextual awareness. Great leaders assess:

- The urgency of the task
- The team's skill and motivation
- The organizational culture
- The long-term vs short-term needs

Leveraging strengths and Understanding Blind Spots

- A personal **SWOT analysis** is a self-assessment tool to evaluate your Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats to improve personal and professional growth.
- After brainstorming and prioritizing, analyze the findings to develop strategies for leveraging strengths, addressing weaknesses, seizing opportunities, and mitigating threat.

Every leader must answer the following questions after creating their personal SWOT Analysis:

- Which strengths do you rely on the most?
- Could overusing that strength cause challenges?
- Which strengths are underdeveloped, and why?

NOTES

LEADERSHIP SKILLS